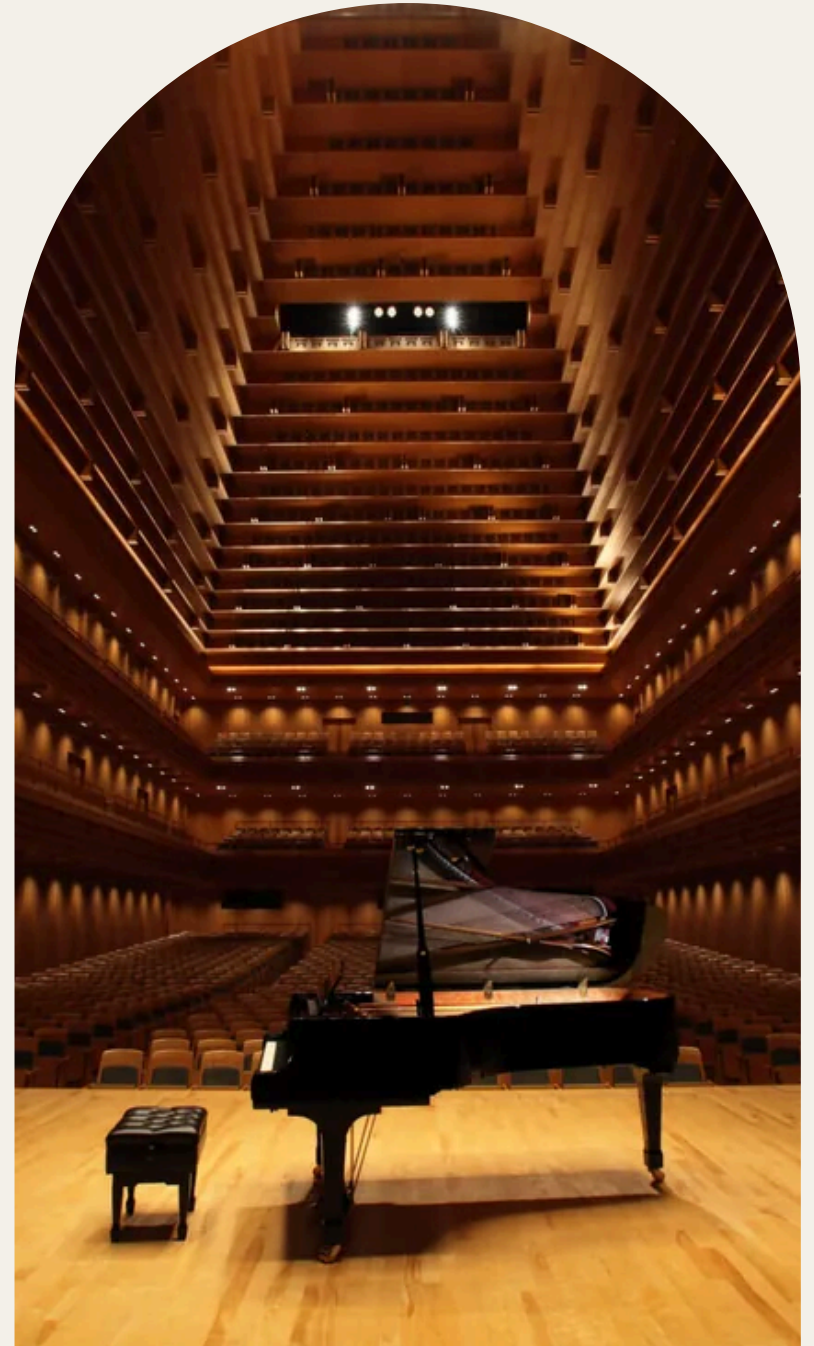


Signature
PIANOS

BRAND GUIDELINES · 19.09.2026

BRAND GUIDELINES *Signature*

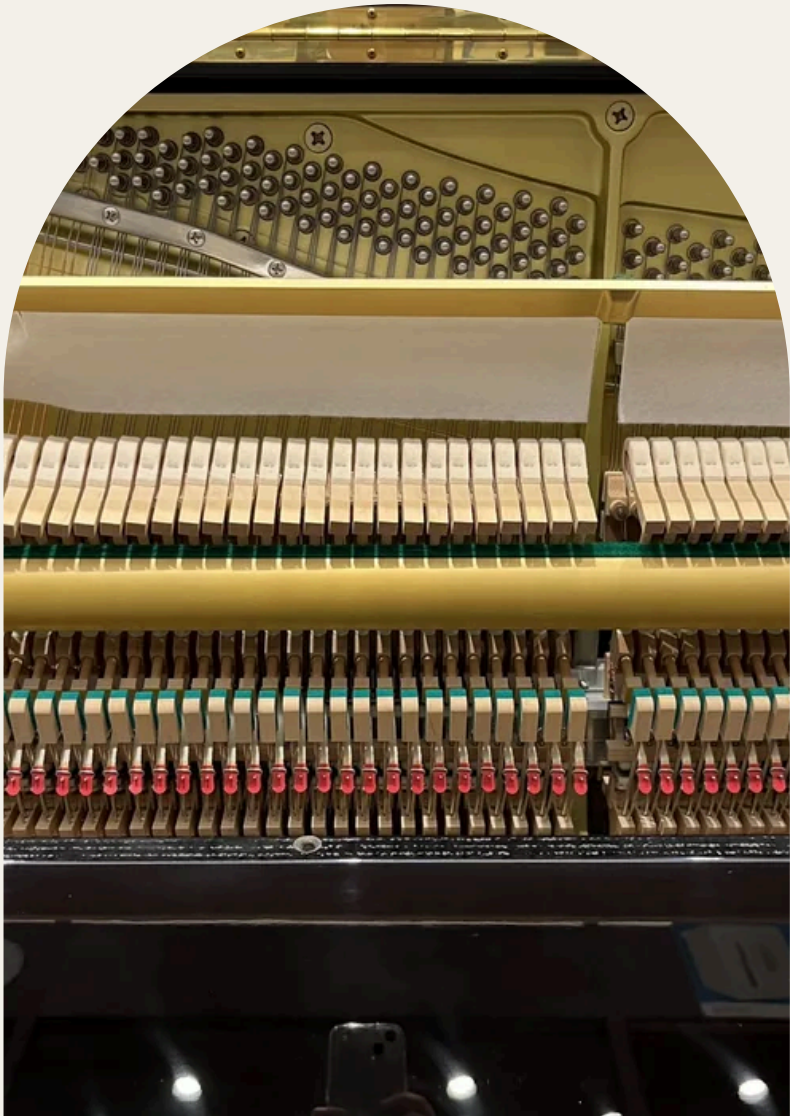
Pianos hand-picked in Japan and checked in Melbourne. New and pre-loved Yamaha and Kawai from our showroom in Mount Waverley.



EVERYTHING THE BRAND NEEDS

and nothing more

The brand	03	Logo	04
Wordmark and monogram	05	Logo misuse	06
Colour	07	Colour in use	08
Typography	09	Headings and sizes	10
Photography	11	Voice	12
Website: components	13	Website: at work	14
Stationery	15	Files and guardians	16



HAND-PICKED IN JAPAN

checked in Melbourne

Signature Pianos sells new and pre-loved Japanese acoustic pianos from a showroom in Mount Waverley. Every piano is chosen in Japan, imported direct and checked in our Melbourne workshop before it goes on the floor. These pages keep everything we make, on screen and on paper, looking like it came from the same room.

WHAT WE SELL

Japanese pianos, imported direct

New and pre-loved Yamaha and Kawai uprights and grands, with the occasional European piano that comes through the same buyers. Each one is photographed in Japan before import.

Digital pianos come later. They stay out of the brand's front door until they are in stock.

WHO IT IS FOR

People buying their first real piano

Parents choosing for a child who has started lessons, usually on a phone, often at night. Adults coming back to the piano after years away. Serious students who know the model they want. People giving a piano as a gift.

None of them should need to know the jargon.

HOW IT SHOULD FEEL

Light, quiet, unhurried

Like a concert hall in daylight before anyone arrives: pale walls, one instrument, room to look at it. The pianos do the talking and the page stays out of their way.

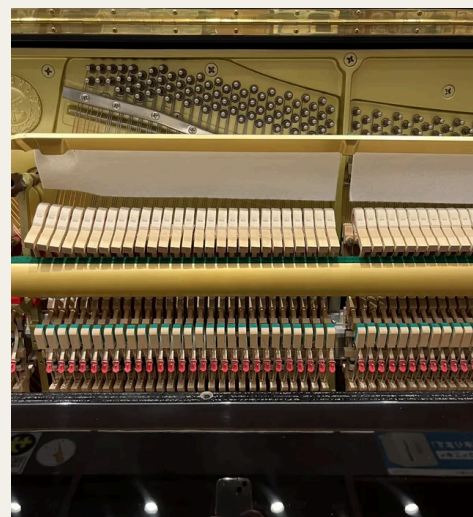
Not the black-and-gold piano showroom.
Not a music shop. Not an agency showreel.

THE ONE RULE

Lead with Japan

Whatever a page, a letter or a post says first, the fact that each piano is chosen in Japan and checked in Melbourne is never more than a line away. It is the reason to buy from us.

When a question is not answered in these pages: lighter, quieter, fewer.



ONE LOCKUP

two lines

"Signature" in Italianno over "PIANOS" in Jost, tracked wide. This is the website header drawn as vector outlines, so it looks the same wherever it appears. Use the master files; never retype it.

FROM THE WEBSITE



The logo is shown within a dashed blue rectangular border. A small "2x" label is in the top left corner of the border. The word "Signature" is in a large, elegant, black script font. Below it, the word "PIANOS" is in a smaller, black, all-caps, sans-serif font, with wide letter spacing.

Clear space

x is the height of the capitals in PIANOS. Keep 2x clear on every side, measured from the outermost ink, including the tail of the g.

Minimum size

Screen	120 px wide. Below 150 px the website sets PIANOS at 9 px so it stays readable.
Print	30 mm wide.
Smaller	Use the monogram.

Which version

Ink	On Key Ivory, White and both Mists
Key Ivory	On Ink and Hammer Felt
White	Over photographs, with a scrim of at least 35% Ink
Black	Single-colour print only: stamps, engraving, newspaper

THE NAME

and its initial

The wordmark is "Signature" on its own, for places that already say "pianos": the fallboard decal, a piano cover, the hero of a page about pianos. The monogram is the script S inside the arch, the shape the website uses to frame its photographs. It carries the brand where the name cannot be read.

WORDMARK



Use

Never

Where "pianos" is already said nearby

As the only mark on a letterhead, card or invoice. Those carry the full lockup.

MONOGRAM

NEW IN THIS KIT



Use

Arch

Favicon, avatars, the foot of the letterhead, the card back, stamps and seals

3 : 4, a semicircular top, a hairline 1.6% of its width

TILES AND ICONS



Ink tile

Felt tile

Ivory tile

Files

Favicon, app icon, Google Business Profile

Instagram and Facebook avatars

Where the ground is already dark

favicon.svg, 16 / 32 / 48 px, apple-touch-icon 180, 192 and 512 px, 1080 px avatars

EIGHT WAYS *to spoil it*

Each of these has happened to a piano dealer's logo somewhere. None of them happens to ours.



1 Retyped in another script or sans. Always use the master files.



2 Recoloured, gold above all. The logo is Ink, Key Ivory, White or Black.



3 Stretched or squashed. Scale it by its corner only.



4 PIANOS moved, enlarged or reset. It sits centred under the script at 10 : 58.



5 Given a shadow, glow, outline, bevel or gradient.



6 Placed on a busy photograph with no scrim behind it.



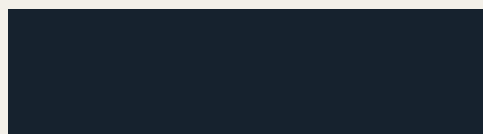
7 Set in a pale colour that cannot be read. Mist on Key Ivory is 1.4 : 1.



8 Rotated, set on a curve or animated letter by letter.

TAKEN FROM *the piano*

Ink is the lacquer, Key Ivory the keys, Mist the light in a hall, Hammer Felt the strip of red felt under the fallboard.
Eight colours in all, with one accent. There is no gold.



Ink

#16222E · R22 G34 B46 · C52 M26 Y0 K82

The logo, headlines, buttons. Our black.

Never pure #000000 on screen.

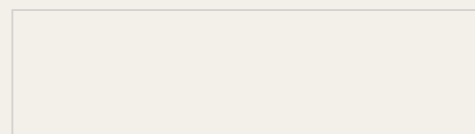


Ink Soft

#3A4855 · R58 G72 B85 · C32 M15 Y0 K67

Body text, labels, captions.

Never for the logo or buttons.

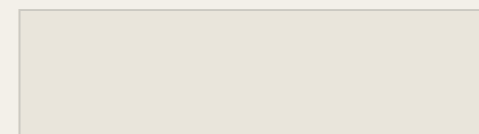


Key Ivory

#F3F0E9 · R243 G240 B233 · C0 M1 Y4 K5

The page. Every screen and sheet starts here.

Never swapped for a cool white.

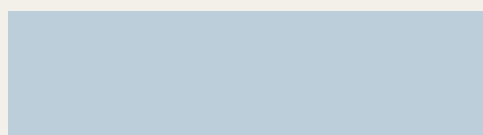


Ivory Deep

#E9E5DB · R233 G229 B219 · C0 M2 Y6 K9

Panels, image frames while photos load,
hairlines on ivory.

Never for text.

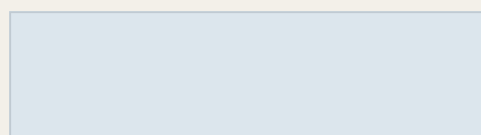


Mist

#BCCEDA · R188 G206 B218 · C14 M6 Y0 K15

One large shape per page: the arch, a band.

Never for text or the logo.



Mist Light

#DCE6ED · R220 G230 B237 · C7 M3 Y0 K7

Alternate section ground: the collection, the
matcher, the top bar.

Never two Mist sections in a row.

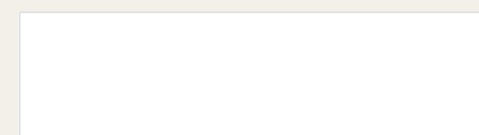


Hammer Felt

#4A1520 · R74 G21 B32 · C0 M72 Y57 K71

The one accent: a block, a pin, a short rule,
the card back.

Never for buttons, links or body text.



White

#FFFFFF · R255 G255 B255 · C0 M0 Y0 K0

Type and the logo over photographs; button
labels; letter paper.

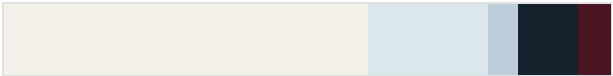
Never as a page ground on screen.

MOSTLY IVORY

a little felt

The page is ivory. Ink carries the words. Mist makes one big shape. Felt appears once, small, the way the felt strip does on a real piano.

Proportion



60 Key Ivory · 20 Mist Light · 5 Mist · 10 Ink · 5 Hammer Felt, by area of flat colour. Photographs sit on top.



The felt under the fallboard: where Hammer Felt comes from, and how much of it to use.

Contrast

TEXT	GROUND	RATIO
Ink	Key Ivory	14.2 : 1
Ink	White	16.1 : 1
Ink	Mist	10.0 : 1
Ink	Mist Light	12.7 : 1
Ink Soft	Key Ivory	8.2 : 1
Ink Soft	Mist Light	7.4 : 1
Key Ivory	Hammer Felt	13.0 : 1
Key Ivory	Ink	14.2 : 1
Mist	Key Ivory	1.4 : 1, never

Every text pairing we use passes WCAG AAA (7 : 1) for body text.

Retired

The dark theme is gone. If any of these turn up on a page, a document or a post, replace them.

Gold #B8935A, #D4B483
Use Ink for buttons, Felt for accents.

Studio black #0E0E0D
Pages are Key Ivory now.

Porcelain #FAFBFB
Becomes Key Ivory.

Steel #2D628C, Slate #5E6F80
Become Ink and Ink Soft.

THREE FACES

three jobs

A script for the name, condensed capitals for headlines, a clean sans for everything read. All three are free under the SIL Open Font License: install them, embed them, send them to the printer.

SCRIPT · ITALIANNO

Signature

Weight	Regular 400
Case	As written, never capitals
Leading	100%
Tracking	0
Use	The wordmark, and one crossing word or phrase (three words at most) per heading
Smallest	40 px on screen, 24 pt in print
Fallback	Snell Roundhand, Apple Chancery, cursive

DISPLAY · NOTO SERIF DISPLAY, EXTRACONDENSED

YAMAHA U3H
KAWAI K-300

Weight	Medium 500 at width 62.5 (the ExtraCondensed instance)
Case	Always capitals
Leading	86–90%
Tracking	–0.5%
Use	Headlines, piano names on cards, big numbers
Fallback	Bodoni Moda, Didot, Georgia, serif

TEXT · JOST

Hand-picked in Japan,
checked in
Melbourne.

BOOK A VISIT · ENQUIRE

Weights	Regular 400 for reading, Medium 500 for buttons and names, Light 300 for print body
Body	17 px, leading 170%, 44–60 characters a line
Labels	12 px capitals, tracking 0.3 em
Fallback	Helvetica Neue, Arial, sans-serif

THE CROSSING

heading

The site's one typographic device. Condensed capitals state the thing; a script word crosses underneath to say how. Script and capitals are set at about the same size, and the script is pulled up by a third of its size so it overlaps.

UPRIGHT
PIANOS
hand-picked

Every pre-loved upright is one of a kind. These were
photographed in Japan before import.

Capitals clamp(56 px, 8.4 vw, 150 px) · script clamp(64 px, 8 vw, 138 px), margin-top -0.32 em

Sizes

ROLE	SCREEN	PRINT
Hero capitals	56–152 px, leading 90%	60–80 pt
Section capitals	56–150 px, leading 86%	34–48 pt
Crossing script	64–138 px, pulled up 0.32 em	Same size as the capitals
Card title	30 px capitals	14–18 pt
Body	17 px, leading 170%	9.5–10 pt, leading 155%
Lead paragraph	17–21 px	11–12 pt
Label	12 px caps, 0.3 em	6.4 pt caps, 0.2–0.3 em
Button	12.5 px Medium caps, 0.2 em	n/a

Ratio: section capitals are about nine times the body size. Sentences are sentence case; only labels and display lines are capitals.

THE REAL PIANO

in good light

Four kinds of picture. The most important is the plainest: the actual piano for sale, photographed in Japan before import, exactly as it is. People trust a real photo of a real piano more than a beautiful one of a different piano.



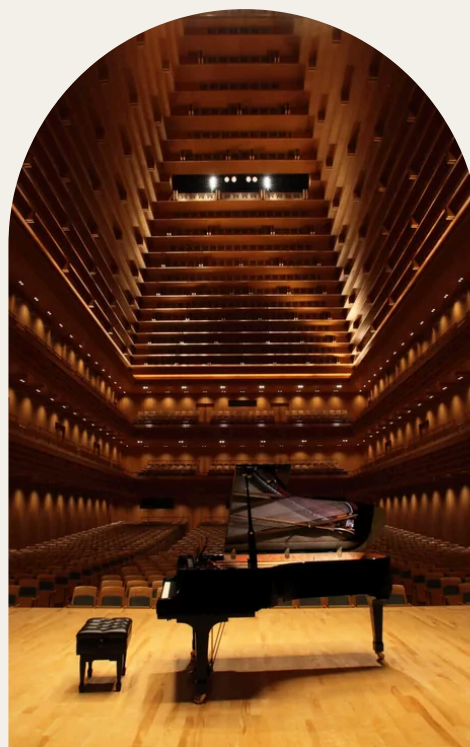
The piano itself

Straight on, whole instrument, lid closed, keys visible. Shot where it stands. The serial-numbered piano we are selling, never a stand-in.



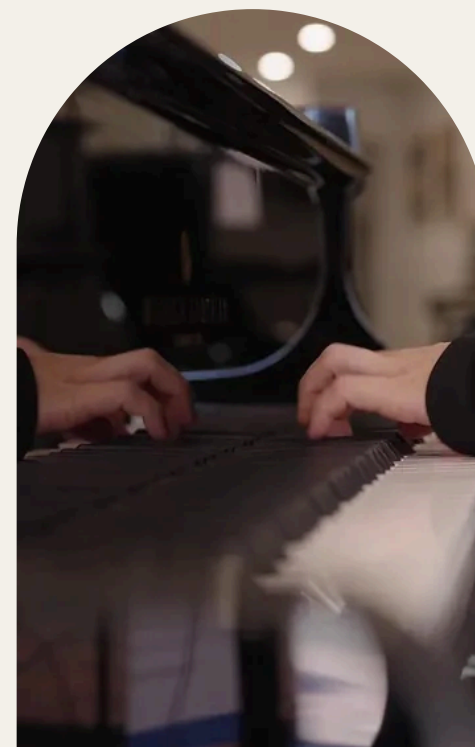
The craft

Action, hammers, strings, pedals, close and sharp. Warm, natural light. Shows what the workshop checks.



The hall

One piano in a large, calm room. For heroes and section openers only, and only with a confirmed licence.



The hands

Someone playing, a lesson, a first try in the showroom. Real customers and teachers, with their permission.

NEVER

Stock families smiling at a keyboard · a piano shown as ours that is not in stock · gold light leaks, lens flare, heavy filters · the black studio backdrop of the old site · AI-generated pianos presented as real · watermarks, phone-flash glare, clutter left in frame

PLAIN WORDS

real facts

We sound like a good piano technician explaining things to a parent: patient, exact, never selling. Australian English. Numbers as numerals. "Pre-loved", not "used" or "second-hand".

RULE	SAY	NOT
1 · Lead with Japan	"Hand-picked in Japan, checked in our Mount Waverley workshop."	"Melbourne's best piano store."
2 · Name the piano	"Yamaha YUS5, 2008, walnut. In the showroom now."	"Stunning premium upright in amazing condition!"
3 · Explain once, simply	"A silent system lets you play with headphones, so the house stays quiet."	"Features SH2 silent technology with CFX binaural sampling."
4 · Reassure with facts	"10-year warranty. First tuning included, three to four weeks after delivery."	"Total peace of mind, guaranteed."
5 · Real people, real reviews	A Google review, quoted word for word, with the reviewer's name as it appears there.	Invented testimonials, or reviews rewritten to sound better. Australian Consumer Law treats both as misleading.
6 · One next step	"Book a visit." One primary action per page, repeated at the end.	Three competing buttons in the hero.

WORDS WE USE

pre-loved · hand-picked · imported direct · checked in our workshop · showroom · play it · book a visit · first tuning included · white-glove delivery

WORDS WE AVOID

used · second-hand · cheap · bargain · best · world-class · unbeatable · stunning · amazing · exclamation marks · "Buy now"

HOUSE STYLE

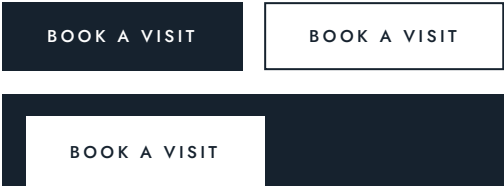
Spelling Australian: colour, centre, licence, jewellery
Prices \$8,900, no cents; "Price on request" while a piano is in the workshop
Dates 19 September 2026 · 10 am · 0479 128 955
Models Maker, model, year, finish: Yamaha U3H, 1981, polished ebony

THE WEBSITE

its pieces

Square corners everywhere. The only curves are the arch and the circle. Buttons are filled Ink and turn to an outline on hover; nothing bounces.

BUTTONS



Filled Ink; on hover the fill fades to an outline over 0.4 s. White over photographs. Jost Medium 12.5 px capitals, 0.2 em. One filled button per screen.

TEXT LINKS

VIEW THE COLLECTION →

BROWSE EVERY TEACHER →
Capitals, 0.18 em, an arrow. On hover a hairline draws in underneath (0.6 s) and the arrow moves 6 px right.



THE RING
A 132 px circle with its label set around the edge, turning once every 22 s. Once per page, in the hero.



THE ARCH
A frame with a semicircular top, for feature photos and the big Mist shape that rises out of the hero. At most two per screen. The monogram is drawn from it.

LABELS AND CARDS
HAND-PICKED IN JAPAN — CHECKED IN MELBOURNE

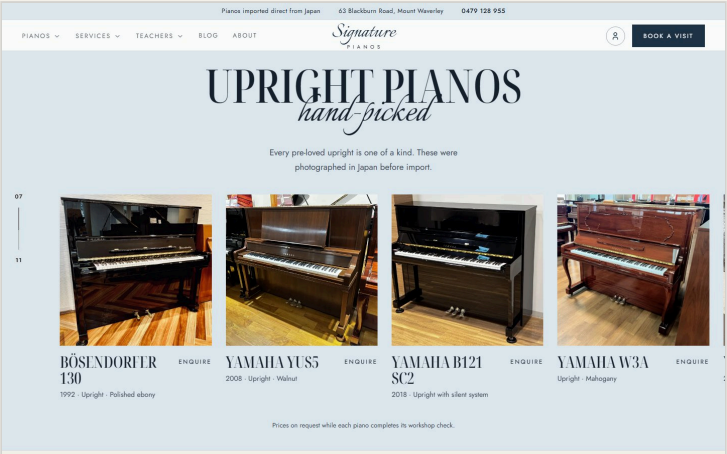
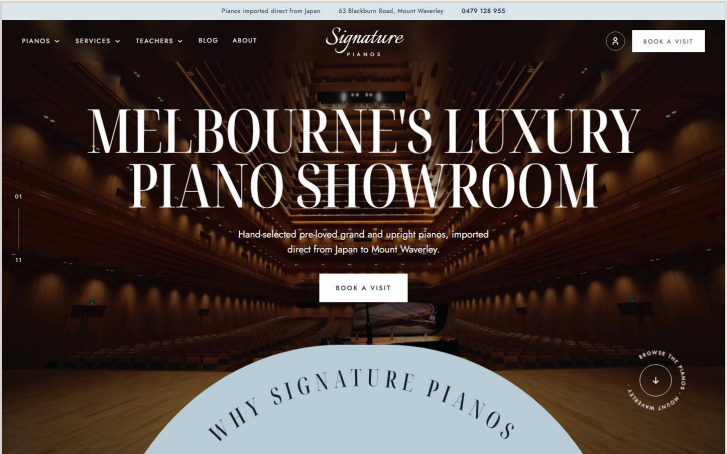
YAMAHA B121 SC2
2018 · Upright with silent system ENQUIRE
Cards have no box: photo, a hairline, the name in capitals, one line of facts, one action.

MOTION
Curve cubic-bezier(.4, 0, .1, 1) for movement
Fades 0.4 s linear for colour and opacity
Reveals Headlines rise line by line; photos grow to full bleed as you scroll
Never Bounce, parallax on text, autoplay sound, anything that ignores “reduce motion”

THE WEBSITE

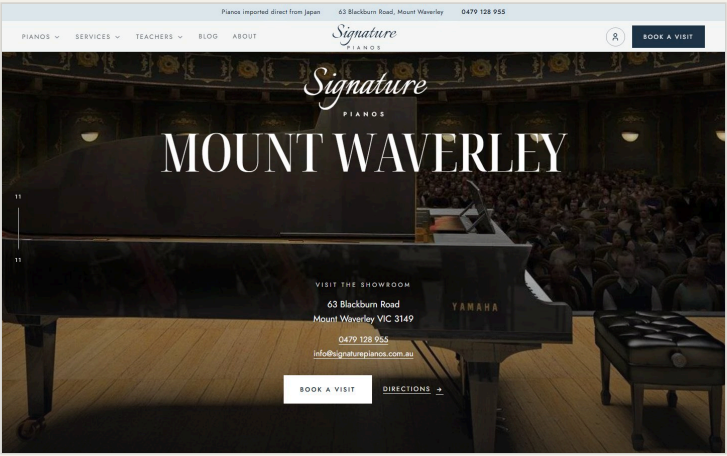
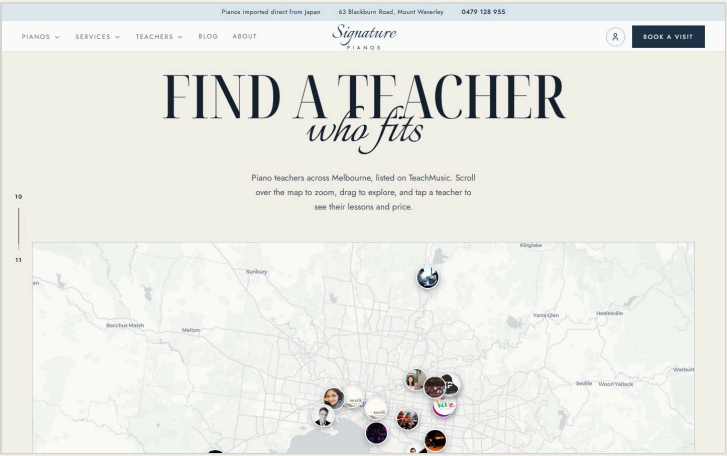
at work

signaturepianos.com.au, 19 September 2026. The hall photograph opens the page, the Mist arch rises out of it with the three reasons to buy, then the real pianos, photographed in Japan.



Hero. The hall photograph, condensed capitals, one line on the import, one button. The script lockup leads the header.

Collection. Mist Light ground, a crossing heading, then each real piano with its year, type and finish.



Teachers. Key Ivory ground, the crossing heading, a quiet map. Pins turn Hammer Felt when chosen.

Visit. The closing section: a photograph, the lockup in white, the address and the one action again.

ON PAPER

and in the inbox

The letterhead centres the lockup like the website header, with a short felt rule under it. The card is ivory on the front and felt on the back. The email signature is the lockup, the facts and one tracked line.



Card front · 90 × 55 mm, 3 mm bleed



Card back · Key Ivory on Hammer Felt



Letter	A4. Lockup 50 mm wide, 17 mm from the top. Body Jost 9.8 pt on 15 pt, Ink Soft, 28 mm side margins. Monogram and address in 6.4 pt tracked capitals at the foot.
Paper	Uncoated white or natural ivory, 100–120 gsm. Cards 400 gsm or heavier, uncoated.
Files	PDF for print, DOCX for typing letters (install Jost first), HTML sources to edit.

WHERE IT LIVES

who says yes

Everything in this document is in the brand folder of the website repository. Anything new that carries the logo is checked by a brand guardian before it goes out.

BRAND /

BRAND-GUIDELINES.md · these rules, in words

tokens.css · colours, fonts and motion as CSS variables

Brand Assets/ 00 guidelines · 01 logo · 02 wordmark · 03 monogram and icons, each in Ink, Ivory, Black and White as SVG, PNG and PDF

Communication assets/ letterhead (PDF, DOCX) · business card · email signature

Fonts/ Italianno · Noto Serif Display · Jost, with licences

src/ the scripts that rebuild every file

BRAND GUARDIAN

Eric

eric@signaturepianos.com.au

0479 128 955

SHOWROOM

63 Blackburn Road

Mount Waverley VIC 3149

info@signaturepianos.com.au

Signature
PIANOS